Finance, Administration and Economic Development Committee Meeting

Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, April 20, 2026
2:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/382709

1. Call to Order

Committee Chair Lawson called the meeting to order at 2:00 PM

Present
Committee Chair Mark Lawson
Committee Vice-Chair Logan Cunningham
Committee Member Gerald Dawson - @ 2:21 PM
Ex-Officio Alice Howard
Committee Member Joseph Passiment
Committee Member Paula Brown
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member York Glover
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik

Absent
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Committee Chair Lawson led the Pledge of Allegiance.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Committee Chair Lawson stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham to approve the agenda.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Committee Member Brown to amend the agenda and move items 8.d and 8.e to be items 8.a and 8.b.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Glover, and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion to amend passed 8:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the motion as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Glover, and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The main motion passed 8:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the minutes from March 16, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Glover, and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion passed 8:0.

6. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken

7. Reports

a. FY2026 Year to date Budget update **(FISCAL IMPACT: N/A)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full update.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/382709

b. Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation Update **(FISCAL IMPACT:)** - John O'Toole
Executive Director, BCEDC

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full update.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/382709

8. Agenda

a. Consideration of Helicopter Acquisition for Beaufort County Sheriff's Office **(FISCAL IMPACT: $4,000,000 from an appropriation of general fund balance.)** - Col Neil Baxley; Chief Hatfield
Beaufort County Sheriff's Office

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to open the item for discussion.

b. An ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Budget Ordinance for Fiscal Year 2026 (ordinance no. 2025/29) to amend section iii, County Operations revenues, and section iv, County Operations Appropriation **(FISCAL IMPACT: $4,000,000)** - Pinky Harriott, Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham to approve an ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Budget Ordinance for Fiscal Year 2026(ordinance no. 2025/29) to amend section iii, County Operations revenues, and section iv, County Operations Appropriation.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham to amend to move $1,950,000 from current fund balance for the purchase of a helicopter and that the remaining money which will total $13,450,000 is for the debt service bonds to be called.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Glover, and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion to amend passed 9:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham to approve an ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Budget Ordinance for Fiscal Year 2026(ordinance no. 2025/29) to amend section iii, County Operations revenues, and section iv, County Operations Appropriation as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Glover, and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The main motion passed 9:0.

c. Consideration of funding to support Project Bamboo- Speculative Building Development- Beaufort Commerce Park **(FISCAL IMPACT: Please see the attached BCEDC pro forma for the full incentive breakdown.**
From Beaufort County Job & Site Fund:

- **$250,000 – Cash Grant at the beginning of the project.**
- **Up to $15,000 in Wetlands Credits**
- **After the certificate of occupancy is issued, there is a potential $1.3 million dollar exposure on carrying cost.**
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FILOT/SSRC Agreement – To be determined.) - John O'Toole, Executive Director, Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation (BCEDC)

Motion: It was moved by Ex-Officio Howard, seconded by Committee Member Brown to approve a consideration of funding to support Project Bamboo—Speculative Building Development—Beaufort Commerce Park.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, and Council Member Glover.

Voting Nay: Committee Vice Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Brown, Committee Member Passiment, Ex-Officio Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, and Council Member Bartholomew. The motion failed 3:6.

d. Mid-Year Funding Request from LRTA dba Palmetto Breeze in the amount of $81,016. **(FISCAL IMPACT: Fiscal Impact is $81,016. If Finance Committee chooses to fund this, Staff recommends utilizing vacancy savings in the General Fund.)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve a mid-year funding request from LRTA dba Palmetto Breeze in the amount of $81,016.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, and Committee Member Brown.

Voting Nay: Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion passed 7:2

e. Approval of a Contract to Revize for RFP #100225 - Website Updates and Redesign **(FISCAL IMPACT: The total first year cost is $96,600. The contract outlines options to renew for up to four additional years at $20,000 per year, subject to budget approved by Council. The accounts that will be funding this project would be $48,300.00 from 1000-10-1150-51110 and $48,300.00 from 1000-10-1152-51110.)** - Hannah Nichols, Public Information Officer (5 minutes)

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve a contract to Revize for RFP #100225 - website updates and redesign.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Committee Member Dawson, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Glover, and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion passed 9:0.

f. A resolution of the County Council of Beaufort County adopting a merit pay policy and associated appendix to the Beaufort County Personnel Handbook **(FISCAL IMPACT: Fiscal impact is built into FY27 budget)** - Katherine Mead, HR Director - 5-10 minutes

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve a Resolution of the County Council of Beaufort County adopting a merit pay policy and associated appendix to the Beaufort County Personnel Handbook.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Ex-Officio Howard, Committee Member Passiment, Committee Member Brown, Committee Member Dawson, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Glover, and Vice-Chair Tabernik. The motion passed 9:0.

g. An Ordinance to appropriate fund balance from Funds 1401 & 1600 to fund the USCB Convocation Center Project. **(FISCAL IMPACT: Fiscal Impact is $1,600,000 from Funds 1401 ($650,000) & 1600($950,000) Fund Balances.)** - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Committee Member Passiment, seconded by Committee Member Brown to approve an Ordinance to appropriate fund balance from Funds 1401 & 1600 to fund the USCB Convocation Center Project.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Glover,

Voting Nay: Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Brown, Ex-Officio Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, and Council Member Bartholomew. The motion failed 4:5

h. An Ordinance to Amend Ordinance 2025/20 to re-allocate funds from the 2025 Series GO Bonds to fund the University of South Carolina-Beaufort's Convocation Center Project. **(FISCAL IMPACT: $9.5M from the Law Enforcement Center project will be re-allocated to USCB's Convocation**

Center project.) - Pinky Harriott, CGFO
Chief Financial Officer

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Committee Member Dawson to approve an Ordinance to amend Ordinance 2025/20 to re-allocate funds from the 2025 Series GO Bonds to fund the University of South Carolina-Beaufort's Convocation Center Project.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Committee Chair Lawson, Committee Member Dawson, Committee Member Passiment, and Council Member Glover,

Voting Nay: Committee Vice-Chair Cunningham, Committee Member Brown, Ex-Officio Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, and Council Member Bartholomew. The motion failed 4:5

9. Adjournment

Ratified: May 18, 2026